Teacher and cover plan — Analysing a practitioner without copying the page

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 3 Part 1 · Big question: How do we conduct rigorous visual analysis of a practitioner's work through annotated studies rather than biography copying?

Learning goals and studio kit

• Analyse a practitioner's artwork using the four-lens framework: Form, Process, Contrast, and Symbolic intent.

• Execute two focused analytical studies (a 5-value tonal structure map and a close-up mark-making transcription).

• Synthesise your visual findings into an original thumbnail concept that adapts the practitioner's method to your own identity theme.

Studio kit: Practitioner exemplar prints, A3 analytical study boards, viewfinders, 2B-6B graphite, fineliners, water-based washes, oil pastels

Arrival and starter

Arrival: What is the biggest mistake students make on artist research pages, and how do real studio artists avoid it?

Starter question: Why is drawing a quick 3-tone 'tonal map' thumbnail of an artwork so revealing?

Teacher model (I do)

Step 1: Draw the 3-value Tonal map (Box 1): I squint at the exemplar print to blur details and block in the dark, mid, and light zones in Box 1, noting the bright halo around the head.

Step 2: Reverse-engineer the mark recipe (Box 2): Using a viewfinder, I transcribe a 6 cm square in Box 2, annotating the three layers: 1. Warm wash, 2. Oil-pastel cross-hatching, 3. Heavy ink contour.

Step 3: Design my Personal adaptation (Box 3): In box 3, I apply that exact 3-tone halo plan and 3-layer recipe to my own architectural/symbolic identity motif.

Practice routes (Supported / Independent / Aspire)

Supported: 3-tone map, viewfinder close-up study, personal adaptation, and three pointer notes completed.

Independent: Tonal map, numbered process transcription, original adaptation, and analytical synthesis.

Aspire: Tonal/vector maps, mixed-media transcription, resolved adaptation, and critical commentary.

TA and cover notes

TA focus: Provide 6 cm viewfinders and demonstrate the 'squint test' so pupils can easily simplify complex prints into three tonal values for Box 1.

Staff prep: Staff preparation only: review how to model visual practitioner analysis (Tonal map -> Transcription -> Adaptation) without biographical text copying.